Northgate Community Food Bank AI use policy

Draft for board review · Effective when the board approves it · Owner: Not yet named; board to confirm · Next review: Not yet set; board to decide

Why we have this policy. We want AI to take routine writing off your plate. We must protect SNAP applicants, donors and volunteers, and keep real people answering real people.

Who it covers. Staff, contractors and board members. Whether volunteers may use AI is not settled.

TOOLS WE USE

- **Gemini in Google Workspace:** Everyday drafting and editing only. No protected information.
- **No other AI tools:** None are approved yet. Ask Ken first.
- **New tools, add-ons and AI features.** Ken approves any new tool, extension, agent or AI feature in software we already have. He checks where data goes. No paid AI accounts this year.
- **Accounts.** Use your work Google account. Ask Ken to confirm vendor training on your input is off.

WHAT YOU CAN USE AI FOR

- Draft volunteer newsletters and social posts in Gemini.
- Write volunteer thank-yous.
- Draft grant boilerplate.
- Tidy your own emails and documents in Gmail and Docs.

NEEDS APPROVAL FIRST

- Any AI use touching SNAP work or donor data — *Marcus, CEO*
- New tool, extension or AI feature — *Ken*
- AI help with recall or allergen notices — *Your manager*

OFF LIMITS

- **Never put this into an AI tool** unless the tool is approved for it above: SNAP applicants' Social Security numbers, income, household members and immigration papers (state human services agreement); Salesforce donor records; volunteer contact and emergency details; court-ordered volunteers' case details; mobile pantry names and zip codes; staff records; passwords and logins.
- No AI chatbot answers SNAP eligibility questions. A person answers the SNAP line.
- No AI images of hungry people. Our photos are real.

CHECK EVERYTHING BEFORE IT GOES OUT

- Check every AI draft for facts, names, numbers, tone and bias. The sender owns it.
- Report numbers come from the inventory system, never AI.
- Compare recall or allergen summaries with the original notice.

DECISIONS ABOUT PEOPLE

- AI never decides who gets food, SNAP help, a volunteer role or a job.
- SNAP staff stay in charge of every application.

BEING OPEN ABOUT AI

- Follow the AI clause in any partner agreement. If asked about our AI use, answer honestly.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Tell your manager and Ken the same day. Nobody is punished for reporting a mistake.

WHO OWNS THIS POLICY

- The board's executive committee approves this policy and any changes.
- Your manager reviews this policy with you.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE BOARD

- Who owns this policy, and how often should it be reviewed?
- May staff keep using personal AI accounts, like ChatGPT and Claude, or do we pay for an approved tool next year?
- Should AI reminder texts in volunteer scheduling stay on, and may volunteers, like group leaders writing shift notes, use AI?
- When do we tell donors, partners and funders that AI helped, and who approves AI use of partner logos given one partner's AI clause?

Sample policy for an invented organization, drafted by Fulton Ring from a mock 30-minute call. Not legal advice; not reviewed by a real nonprofit.